

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Ganganna Rayapati

Address: 20 Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6HX

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Objection to Planning Application DM2025/01591

Dear Planning Officer,

I wish to formally object to planning application DM2025/01591 on material planning grounds. My concerns relate to highway safety, parking stress, residential amenity, and public safety.

1) School-Run Pedestrian Safety and Existing Peak Parking Stress

Avenue Primary Academy has a reported pupil roll of approximately 1,034. This generates very high levels of pedestrian activity at drop-off and pick-up times, including young children, parents, prams and buggies. There is also additional activity from after-school and weekend events.

The introduction of further peak-time arrivals and drop-offs, alongside vehicles circulating in search of parking, would reduce visibility at crossings and junctions and materially increase risk to children and other vulnerable pedestrians. The cumulative impact on highway safety is significant and unacceptable.

2) Inadequate On-Site Parking and Predictable Overspill

The applicant's Transport Statement identifies the Friday prayer "changeover" period as the busiest time and models a worst-case overlap scenario of:

Up to 80 vehicles associated with the overlap period

Only 14 on-site parking spaces

An assumption that 3 spaces may be used by staff, leaving only 11 spaces for attendees

Therefore, up to 69 vehicles potentially parking on surrounding residential streets

This level of predictable overspill would lead to obstruction, unsafe manoeuvring, blocked driveways, pavement parking, reduced visibility at junctions and general harm to residential amenity. The scale of overspill is not marginal - it is substantial and foreseeable.

3) Impact on Elderly and Mobility-Impaired Residents

Overspill parking and informal drop-off behaviour often result in blocked pavements and pedestrians being forced into the carriageway. This disproportionately affects:

Elderly residents

Wheelchair users

Parents with pushchairs

Residents with mobility impairments

In a school-run environment with constrained streets, these impacts are particularly serious and raise clear highway and public safety concerns.

4) Emergency Access and Response Resilience

The surrounding streets are constrained and functionally reliant on single routes of access. Additional on-street parking, double parking, or queuing traffic would materially increase the risk of delaying:

Emergency service vehicles

Refuse collection

Essential service access

This is not merely an inconvenience but a public safety concern.

5) Late Operating Hours and Residential Amenity

The Planning Statement indicates extended operating hours, including:

Community use between 07:00-22:00

Prayer use varying and potentially running until 11:00pm

Late evening dispersal - including raised voices, car doors closing, engines idling, and vehicles circulating - is a well-recognised source of residential disturbance. This would result in sleep disruption and loss of peaceful enjoyment of homes, particularly affecting elderly and vulnerable residents.

6) Constrained Local Road Network and Cul-de-Sac Impacts

Dorset Road effectively acts as the primary vehicular access route to the site. Nearby residential streets, including Balmoral Way, are cul-de-sacs with limited turning space.

In such layouts:

Drivers circulate when parking is unavailable

Three-point turns and reversing manoeuvres increase

Any obstruction affects the entire area due to lack of alternative routes

Even short peak surges can therefore have disproportionate impacts.